

Understanding Packaging in R

In this eighth article in the R series, we shall explore the packaging of R code and publishing it for end users. We will be using R version 4.1.2 installed on Parabola GNU/Linux-libre (x86-64) for the code snippets.



By now we know that the R programming language comes with pre-built functions. The base installation of R provides packages with essential functions.

Install

The default list of packages available in the system can be fetched using the following command:

```
> getOption("defaultPackages")
[1] "datasets" "utils" "grDevices" "graphics" "stats"
"methods"
```

If you need to install new packages in the R console, you can use the command given below to do so:

```
> install.packages("RUnit")
```

You will need to load the library in the R session before

using its functions. For example:

```
> library(RUnit)
```

The present active packages that have been loaded into the R session can be displayed as follows:

```
> (.packages())
[1] "stats" "graphics" "grDevices" "utils" "datasets"
"methods"
[7] "base"
```

You can list all the available packages with the *all.available=TRUE* option to the packages command:

```
> (.packages(all.available=TRUE))
[1] "AMR" "base64enc" "bit" "bit64" "blob"
[6] "brio" "bslib" "cachem" "callr" "cli"
```